STI WEST NEGROS UNIVERSITY
STUDIO-GRADE ACADEMIC PUBLICATION SERIES

Cybersecurity Awareness Guide for Tertiary Students

Defending Personal Identity, Credentials, and Academic Assets Against Modern Digital Threats

STUDENT CYBER DEFENSE MANUAL • STI WNU

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Executive Overview & Conceptual Scope

Collegiate institutions and students constitute fertile targets for sophisticated cyber threat actors. With personal devices interfacing across public campus Wi-Fi networks and cloud learning management systems, security vigilance is an indispensable technical life skill.

This comprehensive handbook equips students with threat identification models, credential management protocols, and practical counter-measures against advanced social engineering attacks.

Document Structure & Learning Modules

Module	Core Subject Matter & Deliverables	Target Competency
Chapter 1	The Modern Campus Threat Landscape and Attack Vectors	Threat Modeling
Chapter 2	Phishing Anatomy, Smishing, and Fraudulent QR Codes	Deception Detection
Chapter 3	Credential Architecture and Multi-Factor Authentication	Identity Hardening
Chapter 4	Public Wi-Fi Vulnerabilities and Encrypted Communications	Network Defense

Chapter 1 & 2: Social Engineering & Deception Attack Vectors

Social engineering bypasses technological firewalls by exploiting human trust and cognitive urgency. Threat actors frequently masquerade as university financial aid administrators, IT helpdesk personnel, or scholarship coordinators.

Techniques encompass spear-phishing emails containing urgent payment warnings, smishing SMS text messages threatening immediate e-wallet freezes, and 'quishing' (fraudulent QR codes placed over legitimate merchant payment terminals on campus).

CRITICAL CORE INSIGHT: University administrative departments and banking institutions will never demand passwords or one-time pins (OTP) via unsolicited chats or email.

Table 1. Campus Cyber Threat Matrix and Tactical Defenses

Threat Vector	Attacker Strategy	Indicator of Compromise	Immediate Defensive Action
Spear Phishing	Fake scholarship stipend email	Suspicious sender domain, urgent threat	Do not click; report to university IT desk
Smishing	Urgent e-wallet account freeze SMS	Shortened suspicious link, request for OTP	Never disclose OTP; verify through official app
Evil Twin Wi-Fi	Duplicate 'Campus_Free_WiFi' AP	Missing lock icon, prompt for email login	Disconnect immediately; activate cellular data
Credential Stuffing	Automated bot attacks on reused passwords	Unexpected login alerts on mobile device	Change master password and terminate all sessions

Chapter 3 & 4: Cryptographic Hygiene & Network Hardening

Password reuse is the single most pervasive security failure among undergraduate students. When a non-academic entertainment site suffers an unpublicized data breach, credential stuffing engines immediately test the leaked credentials against academic and financial portals.

Students must transition to four-word passphrases or encrypted password managers paired with hardware or software-based Time-based One-Time Password (TOTP) authenticators. Furthermore, open wireless networks must be treated as hostile listening environments requiring strict HTTPS or VPN encapsulation.

STRATEGIC TAKEAWAY: Avoid SMS-based two-factor authentication whenever possible; SIM swapping exploits render SMS verification insecure.

Incident Response Plan & Cyber Defense Checklist

If you suspect an account compromise, immediate containment limits lateral damage across your academic and personal digital footprint. Follow this emergency response protocol.

Student Cyber Incident Containment Checklist

01	Immediately disconnect the compromised computer or smartphone from Wi-Fi.
02	Navigate to your master account using a known clean device and terminate all active sessions.
03	Reset primary passwords and rotate security credentials to unique 16+ character passphrases.
04	Notify the STI WNU Campus IT Helpdesk to monitor internal university network logs.
05	File a formal incident report with the PNP Cybercrime Group (PNP-ACG) if financial fraud occurred.

References (APA 7th Edition)

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